

Has Larceny on His Mind

Dressen Plans to Make Use of Aaron's Speed

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CHUCK DRESSEN is a man who isn't afraid to talk and let the conversational chips fall where they may. The new manager of the Milwaukee Braves isn't a bit disturbed over the fact that some people are trying to promote a feud between his new club and the world champion Los Angeles Dodgers, whom he served as a coach last season.

"I don't give a damn what they say about me," Dressen said before the Braves and Phillies met in an exhibition game Sunday. "I said I thought we had a better club than they did, and I do. I wasn't trying to run down their club."

"I certainly wouldn't trade

them team for team. Do you think if we offered them Aaron for Snider, Fairly, Repulski and Moon that Buzzie (Dodger Manager Buzzie Bavasi) wouldn't jump out a window without a parachute in his hurry to make that trade?"

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DRESSEN then launched into a discussion of Hank Aaron's ability, and how he hoped to take more advantage of his talents than has been done heretofore.

"I have always said that Willie Mays is the best all-around ball player, but Aaron is the best hitter. I think Hank could be the best all-around, too. He can do everything, hit, run and throw. A lot of people don't realize how fast Hank is. He could steal a lot

of bases but I don't think he's ever been given the chance. We may try to do something along that line this year.

"We've got several fellows that can run besides Aaron. Ed Mathews and Bill Bruton. I plan to let all of them do a little more on the bases."

Dressen refuses to come right out and predict the Braves will win the pennant, but said, "I told my players we could win it."

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THE Braves, fearful that Red Schoendienst wouldn't come back to be a regular, tried hard to make a deal for a second baseman, Dressen said.

"They just wouldn't offer us a reasonable proposition," he said. "We asked about Blasingame, but you know what they wanted?"

"The Cards offered us Grammas and Blasingame for Cottier, Buhl and Logan. We couldn't go for that, but then they turn around and take Spencer and Wagner, a bench warmer for him, from the Giants."

"As far as Gil McDougald goes, we never got down to cases with the Yankees. Then, too, our scouts say he's gone back a lot, so maybe we're just as well off."

"I doubt very much if we'll make a deal now," Dressen concluded.

DIAMOND DOTS: Johnny Logan, the Braves' shortstop, has indicated he'll be aiming to get back at the Dodgers and Norm Larker, in particular, this season. Logan was put out of commission in the seventh inning of the second playoff game at Los

Angeles last October when Larker crashed into him as the Braves were making a double play. . . . Logan's advice to fellow ball players: Never get into a fight with a civilian or an umpire. Other ball players—"that's all right". . . . Catcher Del Crandall, whose bad back had the Braves worried this winter, reports he has no pain and expects none. "I'm within four pounds of my regular weight," Del said. . . . The Phils are still chuckling over Coach Andy Cohen's boner before Saturday's game. Jokingly, Cohen told the squad: "Anyone who pulls a rock today gets fined \$25." Andy then looked around and realized he had donned the gray road uniform instead of the home white suit.